Theorem 1

In a parallelogram, opposite sides are equal

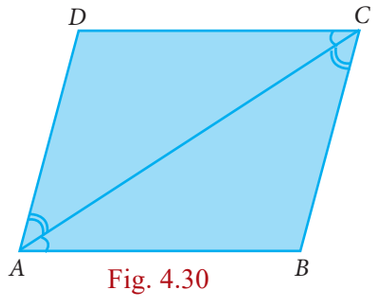


Fig. 4.30

Given $ABCD$ is a parallelogram

To Prove $AB=CD$ and $DA=BC$

Construction Join AC

Proof

Since $ABCD$ is a parallelogram

$AD \parallel BC$ and AC is the transversal

$\angle DAC = \angle BCA$ $\rightarrow(1)$ (alternate angles are equal)

$AB \parallel DC$ and AC is the transversal

$\angle BAC = \angle DCA$ $\rightarrow(2)$ (alternate angles are equal)

In ΔADC and ΔCBA

$\angle DAC = \angle BCA$ from (1)

AC is common

$\angle DCA = \angle BAC$ from (2)

$\Delta ADC \cong \Delta CBA$ (By ASA)

Hence $AD = CB$ and $DC = BA$ (Corresponding sides are equal)

Along the way in the proof above, we have proved another property that is worth recording as a theorem.

Theorem 2

A diagonal of a parallelogram divides it into two congruent triangles.

Notice that the proof above established that $\angle DAC = \angle BCA$ and $\angle BAC = \angle DCA$. Hence we also have, in the figure above,

$$\angle BCA + \angle BAC = \angle DCA + \angle DAC$$

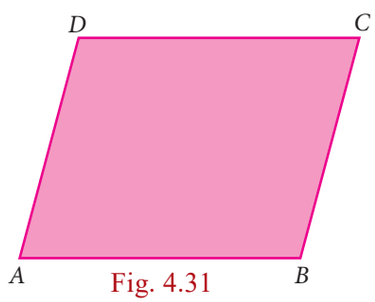


Fig. 4.31

But we know that:

$$\angle B + \angle BCA + \angle BAC = 180$$

and $\angle D + \angle DCA + \angle DAC = 180$

Therefore we must have that $\angle B = \angle D$.

With a little bit of work, proceeding similarly, we could have shown that $\angle A = \angle C$ as well. Thus we have managed to prove the following theorem:

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